

From Prototype to Real Codebase

React + Vite · Supabase · Vercel · i18next · Tailwind CSS

Your tech stack

tool	what it does	cost	why senseUS
React + Vite	Frontend UI framework	Free	Your prototype is already in React. Vite is faster than Create React App.
Supabase	Database, auth, real-time	Free → \$25/mo	Handles users, votes, replies, phone auth, and real-time vote counts.
Tailwind CSS	Utility-first styling	Free	Fast to build with, consistent design tokens, matches your prototype style.
i18next	Internationalization	Free	Built in from day one. Swap languages via JSON files — no code changes.
Vercel	Hosting + deployment	Free → \$20/mo	One-click deploys from GitHub. Preview URLs for every branch.
Twilio Verify	Phone verification (SMS)	~\$0.05/user	Industry standard for one-account-per-phone enforcement.

Before you start — install these

- ✓

Node.js (v18+)

nodejs.org — download
- ✓

VS Code

code.visualstudio.com — download
- ✓

Git

git-scm.com — download
- ✓

A GitHub account

github.com — free
- ✓

A Supabase account

supabase.com — free
- ✓

A Vercel account

vercel.com — free
- ✓

A Twilio account

twilio.com — free

Recommended VS Code extensions

Install these from the Extensions panel in VS Code (Ctrl+Shift+X / Cmd+Shift+X):

extension name	id	why install it
ES7+ React/Redux/React-Native snippets	dsznajder.es7-react-js-snippets	React shorthand snippets — type rfc and hit Tab to scaffold a component
Tailwind CSS IntelliSense	bradlc.vscode-tailwindcss	Autocomplete for Tailwind classes — saves enormous time
ESLint	dbaeumer.vscode-eslint	Catches bugs and style issues as you type
Prettier	esbenp.prettier-vscode	Auto-formats your code on save — keep it consistent
Supabase	supabase.vscode-supabase	Browse your database tables without leaving VS Code
i18n Ally	lokalise.i18n-ally	Shows translation keys inline — essential for multilingual work
GitLens	eamodio.gitlens	Enhanced Git history and blame annotations

Step-by-step project setup

1

Create your React + Vite project

Open a terminal

```
# Create the project
npm create vite@latest senseus -- --template react

# Move into the project folder
cd senseus

# Install base dependencies
npm install

# Start the dev server — you should see a default React page
npm run dev
```

2

Install all dependencies

Install Tailwind CSS

```
# Tailwind CSS
npm install -D tailwindcss postcss autoprefixer
```

```
npx tailwindcss init -p

# Supabase client
npm install @supabase/supabase-js

# React Router (navigation between screens)
npm install react-router-dom

# i18next (internationalization)
npm install i18next react-i18next i18next-browser-languagedetector

# Icons (Tabler – same ones used in the prototype)
npm install @tabler/icons-react

# Date handling
npm install date-fns
```



Configure Tailwind CSS

Tell Tailwind

Open tailwind.config.js and replace the contents with:

```
/** @type {import('tailwindcss').Config} */
export default {
  content: [
    './index.html',
    './src/**/*..{js,ts,jsx,tsx}',
  ],
  theme: {
    extend: {
      colors: {
        brand: {
          DEFAULT: '#2D3DCA',
          light: '#ECEFFE',
          dark: '#1A2490',
        },
        accent: {
          DEFAULT: '#52B788',
          light: '#E1F5EE',
        },
      },
    },
  },
}
```

```
},  
plugins: [],  
}
```

Then open `src/index.css` and replace everything with:

```
@tailwind base;  
@tailwind components;  
@tailwind utilities;
```

4

Set up Supabase

Create you

1. Go to supabase.com and create a new project called "senseus"
2. Once created, go to Project Settings > API
3. Copy your Project URL and anon public key
4. Create a file called `.env.local` in your project root:

```
VITE_SUPABASE_URL=your_project_url_here  
VITE_SUPABASE_ANON_KEY=your_anon_key_here
```

5. Create `src/lib/supabase.js`:

```
import { createClient } from '@supabase/supabase-js'  
  
const supabaseUrl = import.meta.env.VITE_SUPABASE_URL  
const supabaseKey = import.meta.env.VITE_SUPABASE_ANON_KEY  
  
export const supabase = createClient(supabaseUrl, supabaseKey)
```

5

Create your database schema

Run this S

```
-- USERS (extends Supabase auth.users)  
create table public.profiles (  
  id uuid references auth.users on delete cascade primary key,  
  username text unique not null,  
  bio text,  
  avatar text default '■',  
  phone_verified boolean default false,  
  answers_count integer default 0,  
  streak integer default 0,  
  pulse_score integer default 50,
```

```
tier text default 'newcomer',
created_at timestamptz default now()
);

-- QUESTIONS
create table public.questions (
id uuid default gen_random_uuid() primary key,
text text not null,
text_es text, -- Spanish translation
text_pt text, -- Portuguese translation
badge text default 'daily',
region text default 'global',
is_sponsored boolean default false,
sponsor_name text,
published_at timestamptz default now(),
created_at timestamptz default now()
);

-- VOTES
create table public.votes (
id uuid default gen_random_uuid() primary key,
user_id uuid references public.profiles(id) on delete cascade,
question_id uuid references public.questions(id) on delete cascade,
choice text not null check (choice in ('yes', 'lean_yes', 'lean_no', 'no')),
created_at timestamptz default now(),
unique(user_id, question_id)
);

-- REPLIES
create table public.replies (
id uuid default gen_random_uuid() primary key,
question_id uuid references public.questions(id) on delete cascade,
user_id uuid references public.profiles(id) on delete cascade,
parent_id uuid references public.replies(id),
body text not null,
likes integer default 0,
flags integer default 0,
status text default 'approved',
created_at timestamptz default now()
```

```
);

-- Enable Row Level Security
alter table public.profiles enable row level security;
alter table public.questions enable row level security;
alter table public.votes enable row level security;
alter table public.replies enable row level security;
```

6

Set up i18next for multilingual support

Create your

Create this folder structure:

```
src/
  i18n/
    index.js ← i18next configuration
    locales/
      en.json ← English strings (launch)
      es.json ← Spanish strings (phase 2)
      pt.json ← Portuguese strings (phase 2)
```

src/i18n/index.js:

```
import i18n from 'i18next'
import { initReactI18next } from 'react-i18next'
import LanguageDetector from 'i18next-browser-languagedetector'
import en from './locales/en.json'
import es from './locales/es.json'
import pt from './locales/pt.json'

i18n
  .use(LanguageDetector)
  .use(initReactI18next)
  .init({
    resources: { en: { translation: en }, es: { translation: es }, pt: { translation: pt } },
    fallbackLng: 'en',
    interpolation: { escapeValue: false },
  })

export default i18n
```

src/i18n/locales/en.json (sample):

```
{
```

```

"nav": {
  "feed": "feed",
  "explore": "explore",
  "activity": "activity",
  "profile": "profile"
},
"vote": {
  "yes": "yes",
  "leanYes": "leaning yes",
  "leanNo": "leaning no",
  "no": "no",
  "makeUpMyMind": "make up my mind"
},
"onboarding": {
  "getStarted": "get started",
  "whatsYourNumber": "what's your number?",
  "sendCode": "send code",
  "verify": "verify",
  "joinSenseUS": "join senseUS"
}
}

```

7

Project folder structure

Set up your

```

src/
components/
layout/
BottomNav.jsx ← persistent bottom navigation
TopBar.jsx ← logo + search + avatar
feed/
QuestionCard.jsx ← the main question + vote buttons
VoteButtons.jsx ← the 5 thumb buttons
VoteBar.jsx ← the color progress bar
thread/
ThreadView.jsx ← full question + replies
ReplyCard.jsx ← individual reply with actions
ComposeBox.jsx ← write a reply

```

```
profile/
ProfileHeader.jsx ← avatar, username, badges
StreakBanner.jsx ← flame streak display
PulseScore.jsx ← pulse score card
TierProgress.jsx ← tier ladder + progress bar
PowerPerks.jsx ← power user perks list
onboarding/
PhoneEntry.jsx
OTPVerify.jsx
ProfileSetup.jsx
FirstQuestion.jsx
moderation/
ModQueue.jsx ← admin mod review queue
FlagModal.jsx ← report a reply
pages/
Feed.jsx
Thread.jsx
Profile.jsx
Onboarding.jsx
ModQueue.jsx
lib/
supabase.js ← Supabase client
moderation.js ← content screening logic
i18n/
index.js
locales/
en.json
es.json
pt.json
assets/
logo-dark.svg ← your exported globe logo
logo-light.svg
App.jsx
main.jsx
```



Deploy to Vercel

Get your a

1. Push your project to GitHub: `git init` → `git add .` → `git commit -m "initial"` → create repo on github.com → `git push`
2. Go to vercel.com and click "Add New Project"
3. Import your GitHub repository
4. Add your environment variables (`VITE_SUPABASE_URL` and `VITE_SUPABASE_ANON_KEY`)
5. Click Deploy — Vercel handles everything else
6. Every future git push to main auto-deploys. Every branch gets a preview URL.



Add Twilio phone verification

Wire up SM

Supabase has built-in phone auth using Twilio. In your Supabase dashboard:

1. Go to Authentication > Providers > Phone
2. Enable Phone provider
3. Enter your Twilio Account SID, Auth Token, and Messaging Service SID
4. In your app, use `supabase.auth.signInWithOtp({ phone: "+15551234567" })`
5. Verify with `supabase.auth.verifyOtp({ phone, token, type: "sms" })`

Supabase handles the entire phone auth flow including the OTP generation and verification. You don't need to write Twilio code directly — just configure it in the dashboard and call the Supabase auth methods.

Quick reference — useful commands

```
npm run dev # start local dev server at localhost:5173
npm run build # build for production
npm run preview # preview production build locally
git add . # stage all changes
git commit -m "msg" # commit with message
git push # push to GitHub (triggers Vercel deploy)
npx supabase gen types typescript # generate TypeScript types from DB
```

Important reminders



Never commit `.env.local`

Your Supabas
automatically k

!	Use i18next from the very first string	Never hardcode strings. Doing so later is painful.
!	Enable Row Level Security on every table	Supabase's RLS is powerful. Make sure you use it.
!	Copy your SVG logos into src/assets/	The two SVG files are used by your TopBar component.
!	Test on mobile from day one	Run your dev server on a mobile device to catch layout issues early.

Learning resources

tool	url	notes
React	react.dev/learn	The official React docs — genuinely the best place to start
Vite	vitejs.dev/guide	Fast build tool docs — mostly you won't need this
Supabase	supabase.com/docs	Full docs + excellent YouTube tutorials ("Build in a Weekend")
Tailwind CSS	tailwindcss.com/docs	Search for any CSS property and find the Tailwind equivalent
i18next	react.i18next.com	React-specific i18next documentation and examples
React Router	reactrouter.com/en/main	Routing between pages — read the Tutorial section
Twilio Verify	twilio.com/docs/verify	Step-by-step phone verification setup guide
Vercel	vercel.com/docs	Deployment docs — mostly you won't need much beyond the quickstart